

The Three Dolls

A **holy** man **presented** a prince with a set of three small dolls and when he looked bored, **handed** him a piece of **string**.

"Pass it through the hole in the ear of each doll," he said.

Intrigued, the prince put the string into the ear of the first doll.

It came out from the other ear.

"Whatever you tell this type of person," said the man, "comes out from the other ear. He doesn't **retain** anything."

The string came out from the mouth of the second doll.

"With this kind of person, whatever you tell him, he tells everybody else.

"The string did not reappear from anywhere else in the third doll."

Whatever you tell this type of person, never comes out.

"What is the best type of person?" asked the prince.

The man handed him a fourth doll, in answer.

When the prince put the string into the doll once, it came out from the other ear. The second time it came out of the mouth and the third time, it didn't appear at all.

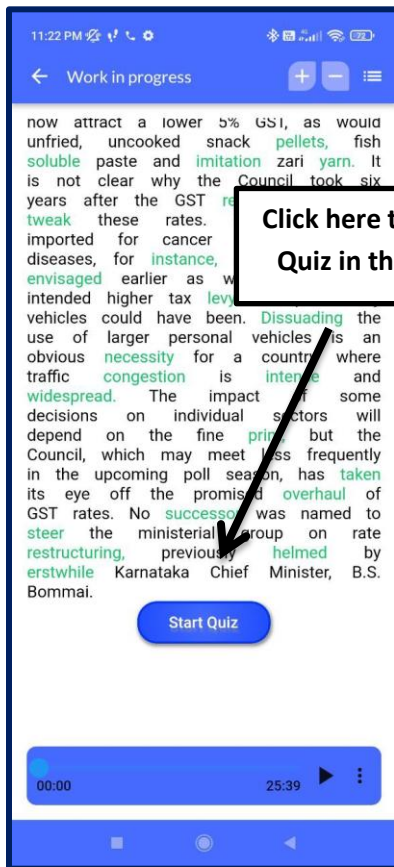
"This is the best type of person, said the holy man. "To be **trustworthy**, a man must know when not to listen, when to remain silent and when to **speak out**."



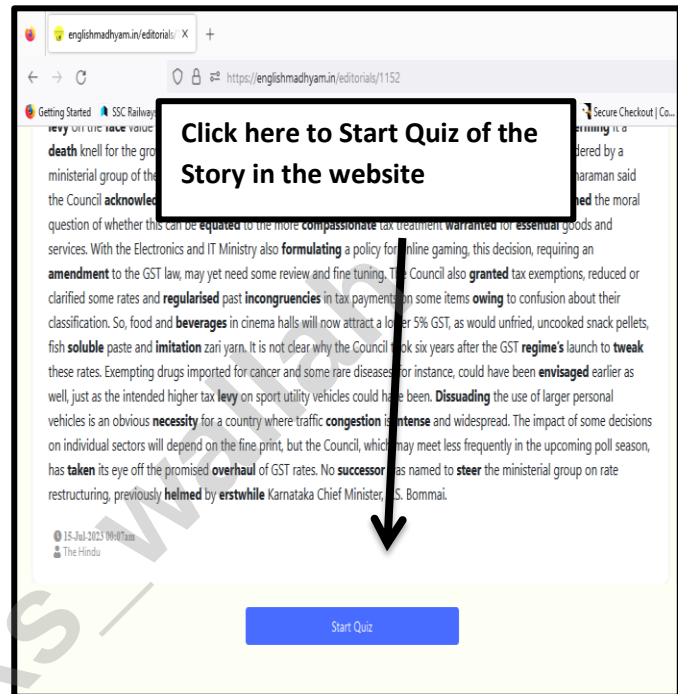
Vocabulary

1. **Holy** (adjective) – Sacred, divine, pious, saintly, consecrated पवित्र
2. **Present** (verb) – Give, offer, bestow, grant, gift देना/प्रस्तुत करना
3. **Hand** (verb) – Pass, deliver, give, transfer, offer सौंपना
4. **String** (noun) – Cord, thread, twine, rope, line डोरी
5. **Intrigue** (verb) – Fascinate, interest, attract, captivate, engross आकर्षित करना
6. **Retain** (verb) – Keep, hold, preserve, remember, maintain बनाए रखना
7. **Trustworthy** (adjective) – Reliable, dependable, honest, faithful, upright विश्वसनीय
8. **Speak out** (phrasal verb) – Express, voice, declare, state, articulate खुलकर बोलना

Practice Exercise



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